Empathy Map

Date	21 October 2026
Team ID	TDS-AI-2026
Project Name	Personalized Travel Itinerary Planner
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Project Title

Personalized Travel Itinerary Planner

Target User Persona: The Modern Traveler

SAYS

- "I spend hours researching destinations but still feel unsure about my itinerary"
- "I want a trip plan that fits my budget without missing the best experiences"
- "Planning for a group is a nightmare — everyone has different interests"
- "I wish I could just tell an AI what I want and get a complete day-by-day plan"
- "I need to be able to tweak my itinerary easily, not start from scratch"
- "I don't want to overspend — I need to see costs upfront for each activity"

THINKS

- "Is this itinerary realistic for my budget and timeline?"
- "Am I missing out on must-see attractions at my destination?"
- "How do I balance sightseeing, meals, and rest without over-scheduling?"
- "Can I trust AI recommendations for real places and accurate pricing?"
- "Will my travel companions enjoy this plan too?"
- "I need a tool that understands my travel style — I like to take it slow"

DOES

- Searches Google, TripAdvisor, and travel blogs for hours
- Creates spreadsheets or notes to organize trip details manually
- Asks friends and social media for travel recommendations
- Compares prices across multiple booking platforms
- Frequently changes plans as new information is discovered
- Tries multiple travel apps but finds none that fully meet their needs

FEELS

- **Overwhelmed** by the sheer volume of travel information available online
- **Anxious** about exceeding budget or missing important experiences
- **Frustrated** with generic travel recommendations that don't match their style
- **Excited** about the trip but stressed about the planning process
- **Hopeful** that AI can simplify and personalize the experience
- **Relieved** when a coherent, budget-aware plan comes together

Pain Points Summary

Pain Area	Intensity	Our Solution
Time spent researching	High	AI generates complete itineraries in 10-30 seconds
Budget management	High	Per-activity and per-day cost estimation within overall budget
Personalization	Medium	Interests, travel style, and group size inputs
Itinerary flexibility	Medium	Edit, delete, reorder activities; regenerate individual days
Group coordination	Medium	Shared trip access with viewer/editor roles
Technical complexity	Low	Clean, intuitive UI with guided form inputs

Empathy Insights Applied to Design

1. **Simple Input** → **Rich Output**: The trip creation form asks only essential questions (destination, dates, budget, style, interests) and the AI handles the complexity
2. **Cost Transparency**: Every activity shows its estimated cost; day totals and trip totals are always visible
3. **Flexible Control**: Users can regenerate any single day, edit individual activities, drag-and-drop reorder, or delete items
4. **Real-World Places**: AI prompts enforce using real places at the destination, not generic placeholders
5. **Travel Style Awareness**: Relaxed (3 activities/day), Balanced (4-5), Packed (6-7) — matching the user's energy level